Gradle Version Catalogs



For this book, we'll set each dependency's version number in the same file we declare the dependency. For more complex Android apps, you can set version numbers in `lib.versions.toml`. The documentation[18] says this:

> Gradle version catalogs enable you to add and maintain dependencies and plugins in a scalable way. Using Gradle version catalogs makes managing dependencies and plugins easier when you have multiple modules. Instead of hardcoding dependency names and versions in individual build files and updating each entry whenever you need to upgrade a dependency, you can create a central version catalog of dependencies that various modules can reference in a type-safe way with Android Studio assistance.

This is handy for when the next version of Hotwire Native is released—you'd only have to change a single line in the `[versions]` section to update both dependencies.

Get the Android App Running

Rendering web content on a mobile app requires a compatible *fragment* with an embedded web view. Fragments in Android are similar to view controllers in iOS: they manage the logic, interaction, and sometimes layout of content. Fragments usually map 1:1 with screens. Hotwire Native provides a fragment with everything we need. All we have to do is put it on the screen and configure it.

Update the Layout

From the left panel, expand `app`, `res`, and then `layout`. This directory contains all the view layouts for the app, currently only `activity_main.xml`. Double-click that file to open it.